

Stationers Company

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Stationers' Hall is on Ludgate Hill, near St Paul's. It has stood there for 350 years, but the Stationers' Company dates back to 1403.

The Company grew after Caxton introduced the printing press to England. In 1557, it received a Royal Charter and became very important in the book trade. Publishers had to register their right to print books at Stationers' Hall.

Two important printers worked on Fleet Street. Robert Copland opened a bookshop and printing press in 1521. He also wrote about poverty and was the first person to print examples of thieves' language in English.

Richard Tottell was a successful publisher of legal books. In 1557, he printed Tottel's Miscellany, the first English collection of poetry.

Stationers continued to work on Fleet Street for hundreds of years. In 1702, Elizabeth Mallet published The Daily Courant, Britain's first daily newspaper. Samuel Richardson later wrote Pamela, one of the first English novels.

Today, the Worshipful Company of Stationers and Newspaper Makers is still active.

